Periodic table

The periodic table organizes the 118 known elements by arranging them based on their atomic number, which is the number of protons in each of their atoms. The elements are placed in rows (called "periods") and columns (called "groups"). Elements with similar properties sit in a group. This table is "periodic" because the characteristics of the elements follow a pattern. New elements may be added to it in the future.

Period numbers

Group numbers

Period	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
1	1 H Hydrogen								
2	3 Li Lithium	4 Be Beryllium							
3	11 Na Sodium	12 Mg Magnesium							
4	19 K Potassium	20 Ca Calcium	21 Sc Scandium	22 Ti Titanium	23 V Vanadium	24 Cr Chromium	25 Mn Manganese	26 Fe Iron	27 Co Cobalt
5	37 Rb Rubidium	38 Sr Strontium	39 Y Yttrium	40 Zr Zirconium	41 Nb Niobium	42 Mo Molybdenum	43 Tc Technetium	44 Ru Ruthenium	45 Rh Rhodium
6	55 Cs Caesium	56 Ba Barium	57–71 Lanthanide series	72 Hf Hafnium	73 Ta Tantalum	74 W Tungsten	75 Re Rhenium	76 Os Osmium	77 Ir Iridium
7	87 Fr Francium	88 Ra Radium	89–103 Actinide series	104 Rf Rutherfordium	105 Db Dubnium	106 Sg Seaborgium	107 Bh Bohrium	108 Hs Hassium	109 Mt Meitnerium
				57 La Lanthanum	58 Ce Cerium	59 Pr Praseodymium	60 Nd Neodymium	61 Pm Promethium	62 Sm Samarium
				89 Ac Actinium	90 Th Thorium	91 Pa Protactinium	92 U Uranium	93 Np Neptunium	94 Pu Plutonium

These two rows, known as the Lanthanides and Actinides, are not periods. They sit next to Group 2, but make the table very wide, so are moved to the bottom.